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The Hindu Editorial Vocabulary

Vocabulary:

1. **Prevalent (प्रचलित)** – Widespread in a particular area or at a particular time.
2. **Repercussions (परिणाम या प्रभाव)** – An unintended consequence of an event or action.
3. **Ostensible (प्रकट रूप से / दिखावटी)** – Appearing to be true, but not necessarily so.
4. **Conundrum (पहेली / दुविधा)** – A confusing or difficult problem or question.
5. **Ephemeral (क्षणिक / अल्पकालिक)** – Lasting for a very short time.
6. **Copious (प्रचुर)** – Abundant in supply or quantity.
7. **Hone (संवारना / निखारना)** – To refine or perfect something over a period of time.
8. **Euphoria (उत्साह / परमानंद)** – A feeling of intense excitement and happiness.
9. **Teeter (डगमगाना)** – Move or balance unsteadily; sway back and forth.
10. **Wrest (छीनना)** – Forcibly pull something from a person's grasp.

PHRASAL VERBS:

1. Head up
Meaning – To lead or be in charge of something.

2. Mess with
Meaning – To interfere with or provoke someone/something.

3. Pan out
Meaning – To turn out or result in a particular way, often successfully.

4. Queer up
Meaning – To spoil, ruin, or make something problematic.

Idioms & Phrases

1. At the drop of a hat
Meaning – Immediately; without hesitation.

2. Pass with flying colours
Meaning – To succeed brilliantly or with distinction.

3. Speak of the devil
Meaning – Said when a person appears just after being mentioned.

4. Storm in a teacup
Meaning – A lot of fuss over something trivial.

5. Slice the pie
Meaning - To the distribution or division of something, like resources, profits, or responsibilities.

Articles (Reading & Skimming)

Article for Reading:
Crippling aid work: on the U.S.'s freeze on foreign assistance

Insularity often stems from contempt, and the kind now being exhibited by U.S. President Donald Trump and his administration is no exception. Withdrawing from international commitments has become a defining feature of Mr. Trump's foreign policy, and the latest decision to freeze foreign assistance adds to the list of drastic moves, following the withdrawal from WHO and the Paris Accord. This decision will disrupt established global aid structures and have dire consequences for the millions who rely on U.S. assistance for survival. While the full impact is yet to unfold, it is clear to those in the development sector that a cascade of negative repercussions is imminent. On his first day in office, Mr. Trump imposed a 90-day freeze on foreign assistance, citing inefficiencies and ideological opposition to USAID. His administration argues that USAID misallocates funds and operates at odds with his policies. Elon Musk, head of the Department of Government Efficiency, went so far as to label USAID a viper's nest of radical-left Marxists who hate America. The official USAID website has been stripped of its content, but announced that all personnel would be placed on administrative leave, with only a few exceptions for mission-critical staff. The administration also ordered the rapid repatriation of overseas USAID personnel within 30 days. USAID was established in 1961 as an independent agency under the Foreign Assistance Act, designed to provide global humanitarian and development aid. According to the U.S. government's official spending tracker (USASpending.gov), USAID was allocated $44.2 billion in the 2024 budget. While this amounts to just 0.4% of the total U.S. federal budget, media reports indicate that it accounted for nearly 42% of all humanitarian aid tracked by the UN in 2024. USAID funds a range of programmes which include health care, food aid (including assistance to Gaza), and policy advocacy. The agency has maintained a strong presence in India since the 1960s, supporting initiatives in education,

immunisation, HIV/TB prevention, polio eradication, and child health. Though direct financial aid to India has declined in recent years, USAID contributions still amounted to over $150 million for the latest fiscal year. However, in many conflict-ridden regions, USAID remains a lifeline. Withdrawing from international aid efforts is more than a bureaucratic shift: it risks leaving millions without food, medical assistance and critical resources. The decision reflects an inward-looking approach that dismisses the interconnectedness of global affairs. As the U.S. retreats from its historical leadership in international development, the world will be left grappling with the consequences of this reckless policy shift.

Article for Skimming:

The saga of regulating India's thermal power emissions

On December 30, 2024, India's Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) issued a notification amending the Environment Protection Rules by pushing back the deadline for thermal plants to comply with sulphur dioxide (SO2) emission norms by three years without any reasons being given. As it happens, the existing deadline for about 20 gigawatts (GW) of thermal plants, all located in close proximity to densely populated areas, was December 31, 2024. This is the latest instance in a nearly decade-long saga that fans of Franz Kafka would find appealing. The MoEFCC revised the emission norms for Indian thermal plants in December 2015 after public consultations, and all thermal plants were expected to comply with them by December 2017 despite it being a tight deadline. This notification tightened the prevalent norms for particulate matter emissions and introduced norms for other emissions, including SO2, for the first time. These norms were understood to be broadly on a par with existing practices in countries such as Australia, China and the United States. Indian coal generally has a lower sulphur content than

other coal, which should have made it easier for Indian thermal plants to meet the SO2 emission norms. But rather than focusing on the best ways to meet the norms — given Indian coal's characteristics — the debate morphed into the challenges around implementing the flue gas desulphurisation (FGD) technology for desulphurisation of high-sulphur coal. Despite the norms never mandating FGDs, the discussion became one about issues such as the scheduling of FGD installations given their long gestation periods and the likely costs of installing them. In parallel, a different discourse questioning the SO2 emission norms themselves also took shape, often driven by different arms of the government. The Central Electricity Authority (CEA) published papers in 2020 and 2021, questioning the need for uniform norms across the country and proposing that its country-wide implementation be phased out till 2035. The CEA also commissioned a study from IIT Delhi in 2022 which concluded that the installation of FGDs does provide air quality benefits but argued for extending the timelines due to issues such as FGDs being expensive, their supply chain being inadequate, and their operation leading to increased coal consumption (and hence greenhouse gas emissions). In 2024, NITI Aayog commissioned the CSIR-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute to conduct a study on this. This study concluded that SO2 emission norms are not important to achieve good ambient air quality in India, and instead the focus should be on particulate emissions. There was also one strand of debate about secondary aerosol formation from SO2 emissions as the reason to have norms for it even though Indian coal is relatively low sulphur. Thus, rather than debating these issues and building a consensus before notifying the first set of norms, it continues robustly nearly a decade after their notification.

Descriptive Writing (Precis writing: & Email Writing)

Original Text:

El Niño is a climate phenomenon characterized by the warming of sea surface temperatures in the central and eastern Pacific Ocean. It disrupts global weather patterns, leading to extreme climatic events such as droughts, floods, and hurricanes. Occurring every two to seven years, El Niño is part of the El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) cycle, which also includes La Niña (its cooling counterpart) and a neutral phase. The warming of Pacific waters weakens the trade winds, altering ocean currents and disrupting normal weather systems worldwide. In India and Southeast Asia, El Niño is linked to weak monsoons, causing droughts and agricultural distress. In contrast, North and South America often experience heavy rainfall and flooding. El Niño also impacts global food production, fisheries, and ecosystems by affecting ocean temperatures and nutrient availability. The economic consequences of El Niño can be severe, affecting agriculture, water resources, and energy production. Governments and meteorological agencies closely monitor sea surface temperatures and atmospheric conditions to predict El Niño events and mitigate their effects through disaster preparedness, water conservation, and adaptive farming techniques. As climate change intensifies, the frequency and intensity of El Niño events may increase, making its study crucial for global climate resilience. Understanding El Niño helps countries prepare for its effects and develop strategies to minimize economic and environmental damage.

Precis

El Niño is a climate phenomenon causing Pacific Ocean warming and disrupting global weather patterns. It leads to droughts in India and Southeast Asia while bringing heavy rains to the Americas. The event impacts agriculture, fisheries, and economies, making early monitoring essential. With climate change potentially increasing its intensity, El Niño's study is vital for disaster preparedness and global climate resilience, helping nations minimize environmental and economic losses.

- **You are an employee at a corporate firm, and you are facing technical issues with your official email account. Write an email to the IT support team requesting assistance.**

To: ……..@gmail.com

Subject: Request for Assistance – Technical Issues with Official Email Account

Dear IT Support Team,

I hope this email finds you well. I am experiencing technical issues with my official email account ([your email address]). The issue includes [briefly describe the problem, e.g., inability to send or receive emails, login errors, or any other specific issue]. This has been affecting my workflow, and I would appreciate your prompt assistance in resolving it. Could you please look into this matter at the earliest?

If any additional information is required from my end, please let me know. Looking forward to your support.
Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Designation]
[Your Department]

Perfection Vocab

- **Monetary Policy Committee** – A governing body that decides interest rates and economic policies.
- **Consumption-focused** – Emphasizing or prioritizing consumer spending.
- **Budget** – A financial plan for revenue and expenditures.
- **Stage** – A phase or setting for events to take place.
- **Capex (Capital Expenditure)** – Funds used by an organization to acquire or maintain assets.
- **Optimistic** – Having a positive outlook.
- **Cash flow** – The movement of money in and out of a business or economy.
- **Mini-stimulus** – A small-scale economic boost.
- **Economic activities** – Actions related to production, trade, and services.
- **Pause** – Temporary stop.
- **Planetary** – Related to planets.
- **Astrophysics** – The branch of astronomy dealing with celestial bodies.
- **Executive orders** – Directives issued by the President.
- **Administration** – The governing body overseeing an organization.
- **Adversely** – In a negative way.
- **Resilience** – The ability to recover from difficulties.
- **Disaster management** – Strategies for handling catastrophic events.
- **Policy advances** – Improvements in governmental plans.
- **Preparedness** – Readiness for emergencies.
- **Bolstering** – Strengthening or supporting.

- **Geospatial** – Related to geographic data.
- **Financial commitment** – Allocated funds for a purpose.
- **Significant** – Important or substantial.
- **Exploration** – Investigating unknown areas.
- **Employed** – Hired for a job.
- **Screening** – Security checks.
- **Holiday season** – A festive period with high travel.
- **Process** – A series of steps taken to complete a task.
- **Staff** – Employees or personnel.
- **Flashy** – Showy or extravagant.
- **Branded** – Having a recognizable brand.
- **Success journey** – The path to achievement.
- **Way** – Manner or approach.
- **Unchecked** – Not controlled or monitored.
- **Electrifies** – Converts to electricity-based systems.
- **End-use applications** – Final consumption of energy.
- **Demand** – The need for goods or services.
- **Scenario** – A predicted or assumed situation.
- **Attempt** – Effort to accomplish something.
- **Surprise** – An unexpected event.
- **Party** – A gathering for celebration.
- **Guest of honor** – A special invitee.
- **Discovered** – Found out.
- **Envisions** – Imagines a future possibility.
- **Infrastructure** – Basic physical systems of a country.
- **Renewable energy** – Energy from sustainable sources.
- **Majority** – More than half.
- **Power** – Supply of electricity.
- **Drenched** – Completely wet.
- **Unexpected** – Not foreseen.
- **Remembered** – Recalled or did not forget.

- **Umbrella** – A device for protection from rain.
- **Would not get** – Incorrect use of conditionals.
- **Founded** – Established (correct usage).
- **Awareness** – Knowledge or consciousness.
- **Activists** – People advocating for a cause.
- **Sustainable** – Eco-friendly and long-lasting.
- **Living practices** – Daily habits and routines.
- **Inaugural** – First or initial.
- **Readiness** – Preparedness.
- **Recruit** – Hire employees.
- **Green technologies** – Eco-friendly innovations.
- **QS World Future Skills Index** – A ranking of job markets.
- **Paris Pact** – Climate agreement to reduce emissions.
- **Pledges** – Promises or commitments.
- **Drop** – Reduce or decrease.
- **Emissions** – Release of pollutants.
- **Public awareness** – General knowledge about a topic.
- **Ascertained** – Determined or verified.
- **Test report** – Document with evaluation results.
- **Transport vehicles** – Cars, trucks, and other means of travel.
- **Access** – The ability to obtain or use something.
- **Alternatives** – Substitute options.
- **Infrastructure** – Physical and organizational structures.
- **Reduce** – Lower or minimize.
- **Carbon emissions** – Greenhouse gas output.
- **Combat** – Fight against.
- **Psychological well-being** – Mental and emotional health.
- **Programs** – Structured plans or activities.
- **Funding** – Financial support.
- **Policies** – Rules or strategies.
- **Crisis** – Severe problem.

- **Technological advancements** – New developments in technology.
- **Economic inequality** – The gap between rich and poor.
- **Retraining** – Learning new skills.
- **Export markets** – Selling goods internationally.
- **Growth** – Economic expansion.
- **Affective computing** – AI recognizing human emotions.
- **Algorithms** – Mathematical rules in computing.
- **Simulation** – Imitation of a real-world process.
- **Human feeling** – Emotional states.
- **Combinatorial explosion** – A rapid increase in possibilities.
- **Carbon tax** – A fee on carbon emissions.
- **Economic boom** – Rapid economic growth.
- **Labour force** – Working population.
- **Demographic shifts** – Changes in population structure.
- **Incentivize** – Motivate or encourage.
- **Interventions** – Government actions.
- **Systemic deficiencies** – Flaws in a system.
- **Impunity** – Freedom from consequences.
- **Corruption** – Dishonest practices.
- **Enforcement** – Implementation of laws.
- **Sanctions** – Penalties imposed on countries.
- **Geopolitical** – Related to international relations.
- **Trajectory** – Path or direction.
- **Leverage** – Strategic advantage.
- **Efficacy** – Effectiveness.
- **Unprecedented** – Never happened before.
- **Discretionary spending** – Non-essential expenses.
- **Retrenchment** – Reduction of spending or jobs.
- **Catalyze** – Speed up a process.
- **Innovation** – Introduction of new ideas.

- **Generative AI** – AI that creates new content.
- **Ecosystem** – A system or network.
- **Frugal innovator** – Cost-efficient creator.
- **Scalability** – Ability to expand.
- **Cost efficiency** – Maximizing output with minimal cost.

Perfection(with annotation)pdf

SBI CLERK PRELIMS TEST

30 Ques

20 minutes

One go

ED -
CBD/WD/PR/WS
Fillers
CT
PJ
RC

+1 -.25 → Score

Question 1:

than expected personal income tax **(A)**/ Monetary Policy Committee meeting **(B)**/ adjustments now sets the stage for **(C)**/ monetary policy to take over in the February **(D)**/ a consumption-focused Budget with larger **(E)**

CD + than

EA

(a) CEDBA

(b) DBECA

(c) EACDB

(d) BACED

(e) No arrangement required

Question 2:

in central government capex for December 2024 will **(A)/** we are optimistic that the 95% year-on-year growth **(B)/** improve the cash flow in the economy and act **(C)/** activities which are connected to public capex **(D)/** as a mini-stimulus for different kinds of economic **(E)**

Adj

will + v1

AC

(a) ACDBE

(b) DBECA

(c) CAEBD

(d) BACED

(e) No arrangement required

d

Question 3:

NASA has ordered a pause on all **(A)/** work by key planetary and astrophysics **(B)/** science committees due **(C)/** to recent executive orders **(D)/** by President Donald Trump **(E)**

(a) CDEBA

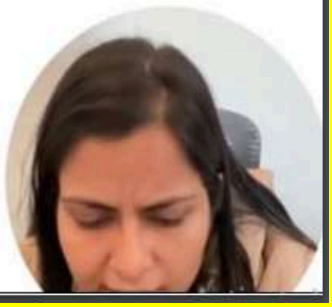
(b) DBECA

(c) EDCAB

(d) BACED

(e) No arrangement required

e



Question 4:

in response to an adversely changing climate **(A)/** important to reflect on our policy advances **(B)/** management, preparedness and resilience **(C)/** while stepping into the second month of 2025, it is **(D)/** and responses in the arena of disaster **(E)**

DB

(a) ECDBA

(b) DBECA

(c) EDCAB

(d) DAEBC

(e) No arrangement required

Question 5:

at bolstering space exploration, satellite **(A)/** the Union Budget has outlined a big vision **(B)/** technology and geospatial capabilities **(C)/** for India's space sector by making a **(D)/** significant financial commitment aimed **(E)**

AC

DA DB

(a) BDEAC

(b) DBECA

(c) EDCAB

(d) BACED

(e) No arrangement required

Direction (6-10): Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank.

Question 6:

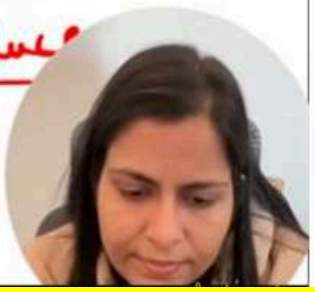
The airport security team employed additional staff to _____ the screening process during the busy holiday season.

(a) expedite
(b) preach
(c) rife
(d) vitalise
(e) undertook

Question 7:

Buying branded clothes and a flashy sports car was just his _____ way of showing his enemies that he was performing well in his success journey.

(a) collate
(b) capricious
(c) meretricious
(d) baleful
(e) attenuate



Question 8:

In a scenario where consumption _____ unchecked and India electrifies all end-use applications, the power demand could increase nine- to ten-fold by 2070.

(a) peeks

(b) arises

(c) elevation

(d) rises

(e) alleviation

Question 9:

His attempt at a surprise party went _____ when the guest of honour discovered the plans in advance.

(a) germane

(b) awry

(c) slender

(d) encroachment

(e) elude

Question 10:

The government _____ a future where renewable energy sources power the majority of the country's infrastructure.

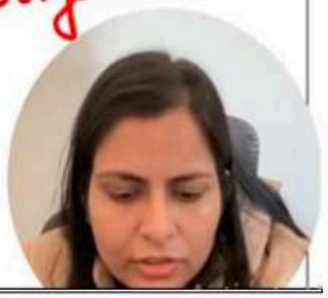
(a) roils

(b) demotes

(c) critique

(d) stems

(e) envisages



Question 11:

If I had remembered to bring my **(A)**/ umbrella this morning, I **(B)**/ would not get drenched in **(C)**/ the unexpected rain on my way to work. **(D)**

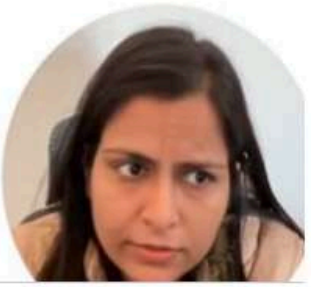
(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

(d) D

(e) No error



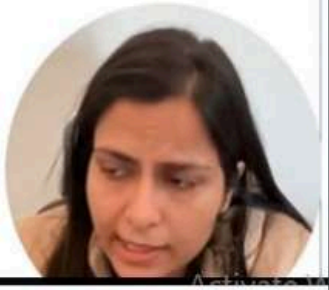
Question 12:

The environmental group was founded by a team **(A)**/ of passionate activists who **(B)**/ wanted to raise awareness about climate change **(C)**/ and promote sustainable living practices. **(D)**

find found found
~~found~~ founded founded

establish

(a) A
(b) B
(c) C
(d) D
(e) No error

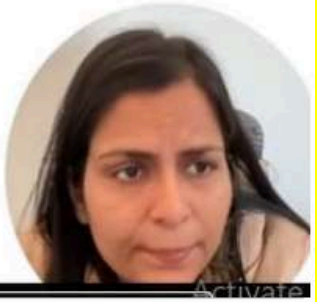


Question 13:

The inaugural QS World Future Skills Index has **(A)**/ ranked Indian job market as second only **(B)**/ to the US in terms of readiness to recruit **(C)**/ for advanced digital and green technologies. **(D)**

US USSR
the UK
UAE
EU

(a) A
(b) B
(c) C
(d) D
(e) No error



Question 14:

If all countries were to meet **(A)**/ their current Paris Pact **(B)**/ pledges by 2030, emissions **(C)**/ would drop by only 10 per cent. **(D)**

(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

(d) D

(e) No error

Question 15:

There is a need for greater public awareness **(A)**/ of how the health of transport vehicles **(B)**/ are ascertained and there should be access **(C)**/ to each vehicle's latest test report. **(D)**

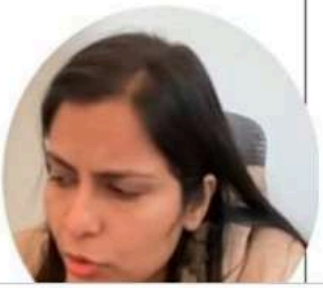
(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

(d) D

(e) No error



Question 16:

A. Renewable energy sources such as solar, wind, and hydropower are increasingly being adopted as alternatives to fossil fuels.

B. _____

C. Governments and private companies are investing heavily in renewable energy infrastructure to reduce carbon emissions and combat climate change.

D. However, the transition to renewable energy is not without challenges, including high initial costs and the need for advanced technology.

E. Despite these obstacles, the shift to renewable energy is seen as essential for achieving a sustainable future.

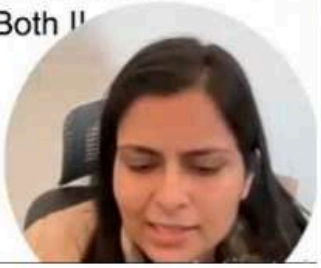
Which of them would be the second line of the passage?

I. The increasing use of renewable energy in industrial sectors is helping businesses lower their operational costs while promoting sustainability.

II. Fossil fuels continue to dominate the global energy market, but their environmental impact is driving the search for cleaner alternatives.

III. Renewable energy projects often face opposition from local communities due to concerns about land use and environmental impact.

(a) Only II
(b) Only III
(c) Only I
(d) Both I and III
(e) Both II



Question 17:

A. Mental health has gained increasing attention in recent years, as more people recognize the importance of psychological well-being.

B. Many organizations are now offering mental health programs to support employees and promote well-being in the workplace.

C. _____

D. Experts emphasize the need for comprehensive mental health policies and increased funding to address these challenges.

E. Without adequate support, the mental health crisis could continue to worsen, affecting millions of lives worldwide.

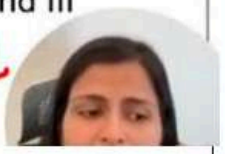
What would be the third part of the passage?

I. The COVID-19 pandemic has exacerbated mental health issues, leading to a surge in anxiety and depression cases globally.

II. Mental health disorders such as depression and anxiety are among the leading causes of disability worldwide.

III. Despite this growing awareness, many individuals still face barriers to accessing mental health care, such as stigma and lack of resources.

(a) Only I
(b) Only III
(c) Only II
(d) Both I and III
(e) Both II and III



Direction (18-20): In the questions given below, parts of sentences have been divided and put in Columns I and II. You are required to match the parts given in Column I to that of those in Column II to make grammatically correct sentences and mark the option containing the best combinations as your answer.

Context

Ramesh is a good student.

He wakes up early.

[ ]

So He should start sleeping early.

(E) → His friends take him to parties late at night

(F) He has sleeping disorders.

Column I	Column II
(A) Technological advancements are reshaping industries and driving productivity gains,	(D) with a significant wealth gap between the affluent and marginalised populations.
(B) Economic inequality continues to be a pressing issue,	(E) leading to discussions about workforce retraining and upskilling.
(C) The country is exploring opportunities for international trade agreements	(F) to expand export markets and stimulate economic growth.

Question 18:

(a) Both B-F and C-D

(b) A-F, B-D and C-E

(c) A-F, B-E and C-D

(d) A-E, B-D and C-F

(e) None of these

(d)

Column I	Column II
(A) AI research has developed tools to represent specific domains	(D) that recognize, interpret, process or simulate human feeling, emotion and mood.
(B) Many of these algorithms proved to be insufficient	(E) for solving large reasoning problems because they experienced a "combinatorial explosion"
(C) Affective computing is an interdisciplinary umbrella that comprises systems	(F) such as objects, properties, categories and relations between objects.

Question 19:

(a) Both A-E and C-D

(b) A-E, B-D and C-F

(c) A-F, B-E and C-D

(d) Both A-E and C-F

(e) None of these

C

Column I	Column II
(A) The implementation of a carbon tax aimed to address environmental concerns	(D) leading to increased productivity and economic growth.
(B) The labour force participation rate dropped due to demographic shifts	(E) an online army of the organisation to fight back.
(C) An economic boom in the technology sector drove job creation and innovation	(F) and incentivize companies to adopt greener practices.

Question 20:

(a) ~~A-F, B-E and C-D~~

(b) Both A-F and C-D

(c) ~~A-E, B-F and C-D~~

(d) ~~Both~~ A-E and B-D

(e) None of these

B

Question 21:

The government's **(A) overwhelming** interventions, though well-intentioned, proved to be mere **(B) stopgap** measures, failing to address the underlying systemic deficiencies **(C) patronage** the economy.

Despite the **(D) plaguing** evidence of corruption, the high-ranking officials operated with near **(E) impunity**, their actions shielded by political **(F) palliative** and a legal framework that selectively enforced laws.

(a) ~~DFCBEA~~

(b) ~~FDBCEA~~

(c) FBDAEC

(d) ~~DBFCAE~~

(e) ~~No rearrangement required~~

Question 22:

The debate surrounding the **(A) leverage** of international sanctions as a tool for geopolitical **(B) trajectory** continues to be polarised, with some experts asserting their ineffectiveness in achieving meaningful political change and others emphasising their capacity to **(C) degraded** adversary economies.

The student's once-promising academic **(D) disrupt** was **(E) culminating** by a series of poor decisions and a lack of discipline, **(F) efficacy** in a dramatic decline in both performance and motivation.

(a) ~~CBADFE~~

(b) ~~CDABEF~~

(c) ~~FDBAEC~~

(d) FADBCE

(e) ~~No rearrangement required~~

Question 23:

Adj Noun

The economic **(A) unprecedented** that followed the financial crisis of 2008 was particularly harsh in sectors reliant on **(B) discretionary** spending, where businesses found it increasingly difficult to sustain operations amidst **(C) influx** demand and reduced consumer confidence.

Adj Noun

The **(D) retrenchment** of capital into the startup ecosystem in Silicon Valley has the potential to **(E) plummeting** innovation at an **(F) catalyze** scale, creating a breeding ground for disruptive technologies that could redefine entire industries within a few years.

_ B E _ _ _

(a) ~~CABDEF~~

(b) DBECFA

(c) ~~DBCEAF~~

(d) ~~CDBAFE~~

(e) ~~No rearrangement require~~

Liang Wenfeng hasn't graduated from any of the fancy Ivy League universities, nor does he work in one of the storied Big Tech names. Yet, this Zhejiang University graduate has __(A)__ the generative artificial intelligence (AI) ecosystem, prompting even Donald Trump to treat the two-year-old DeepSeek as a wake-up call. For once, there can be no debate over Trump's messaging. The Chinese local language model (LLM) maker's launch of its reasoning model R1 last week has challenged not just the **dominance** of players like OpenAI but has also questioned America's supremacy in the global AI race. For an industry built on the belief that scale is king, DeepSeek may be representing the start of a new era — one in which innovation, rather than sheer resources, determines success.

In the process, it has hurt existing tech monoliths where it hurts the most by pushing the boundaries of cost efficiency and scalability. Its models are designed to operate with lower computational requirements, making them more accessible to smaller enterprises and start-ups. Consider this: DeepSeek claims it has created the model within two months and with a training cost of less than $6 million. Compare this with the $100 million that OpenAI reportedly spent on training its GPT-4 model.

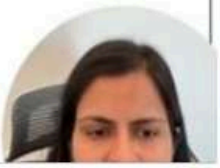
DeepSeek

computational requirements, making them more accessible to

The R1 model, in fact, offers developers, researchers, and organisations seeking AI solutions $0.55 per million input tokens and $2.19 per million output tokens. This is simply unbelievable, given that OpenAI charges $15 per million input tokens and $60 per output token. In addition, DeepSeek's models are open-source and therefore free of charge to a host of users. DeepSeek's emergence as a **frugal** innovator should give hope to countries like India and its tech ecosystem to build their own AI models. For generations, we have heard of India's reputation as a frugal innovator and so, it's time to get out of the fringes. Liang has been vocal about China's need to innovate rather than imitate, claiming that the real gap between Chinese and American AI lies in originality. Our desi tech gurus have also been claiming the same and it's high time they put their noble thoughts into action. There is no denying that Indian industry currently is very service-oriented and the focus is more on implementing technology. On its part, the government needs to lend the industry a helping hand as the key lies in fostering a supportive ecosystem for innovation, providing adequate funding, and cultivating a risk-tolerant mindset among researchers and entrepreneurs.

implementing technology. On its part, the government needs to

Of course, one needs to be careful as the openness also comes with risks. Making such a powerful model freely available raises concerns about misuse. Concerns have been voiced about the potential security implications for the open-source models. Many have said that DeepSeek's open-source nature opens it up for exploration — by both adversaries and enthusiasts. Due to its cost-effectiveness, various products and companies will adopt DeepSeek, which potentially carries significant privacy risks. The regulators and the developers thus have their task cut out. The former will have to create a framework that fosters innovation while mitigating risks through adequate guardrails, and the latter should focus on building efficient and ethical AI solutions that address real-world problems. But this should not be used as familiar excuses to keep delaying the changes that are necessary. DeepSeek has just told us AI can be a tool for everyone — not just the few with billions to spend.



Yet, this Zhejiang University graduate has __(A)__ the generative artificial intelligence (AI) ecosystem, prompting even Donald Trump to treat the two-year-old DeepSeek as a wake-up call. For once, there can be no debate over Trump's messaging. **Question 24:**

Choose the most suitable phrasal verb to fill the given **blank (A)** to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct.

I. shaken up

II. stirred up

III. woken up

(a) Both I and II

(b) Both II and III

(c) Only III

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

Question 25:

Which of the following is the "**TRUE**" statement based on the given passage?

I. DeepSeek's R1 model challenges the dominance of OpenAI and questions America's supremacy in the global AI race.

II. DeepSeek's models are designed to operate with higher computational requirements, making them less accessible to smaller enterprises.

III. DeepSeek's open-source nature raises concerns about misuse and security implications.

(a) Only III

(b) Both I and II

(c) Only II

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

d

Question 26:

Based on the passage, which of the following statements most accurately reflects the relationship between innovation and resources in the AI industry?

(a) Innovation is less important than sheer resources in determining success in the AI industry.

(b) DeepSeek marks a shift where success is driven by innovation rather than mere resources.

(c) The AI industry is built on the belief that resources are irrelevant to innovation.

(d) Innovation and resources are mutually exclusive in the AI industry.

(e) DeepSeek's success is solely due to its access to vast resources.

b

Question 27:

What shift in approach does the passage advocate for in relation to AI development?

I. A focus on public-private collaboration to speed up AI development and ensure its ethical use.

II. A move towards open-source models to make AI accessible to many enterprises.

III. A shift from service-oriented approaches to innovation-driven approaches.

(a) Only I

(b) Both I and II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Only II

(e) All I, II and III

d

Question 28:

Which of the following is the "**FALSE**" statement based on the given passage?

I. The training cost for DeepSeek's R1 model was under 6 million, whereas OpenAI's GPT-4 model was developed with a training cost of 100 million.

II. The potential privacy risks associated with DeepSeek are significant, but its cost-effectiveness is likely to lead to its adoption by various products and companies.

III. DeepSeek's open-source models are more expensive than OpenAI's models.

(a) only I

(b) Both II and III

(c) Both I and III

(d) only III

(e) All I, II and III

The Chinese local language model (LLM) maker's launch of its reasoning model R1 last week has challenged not just the **dominance** of players like OpenAI but has also questioned America's supremacy in the global AI race.

Question 29:

Which of the following options can be the appropriate **Synonym(s)** of the word **'dominance'**, as used in the above passage?

I. ascendancy

II. preeminence

III. subservience

(a) Both I and III

(b) Only II

(c) Both I and II

(d) Only III

(e) All I, II and III

DeepSeek's emergence as a **frugal** innovator should give hope to countries like India and its tech ecosystem to build their own AI models.

Question 30:

Which of the following options can be the appropriate **Antonym(s)** of the word **"frugal"**, as used in the above passage?

I. subversive

II. profligate

III. extravagant

(a) Only I

(b) Both II and III

(c) Only II

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III